

Resources for Black and Historically Underserved Farmers

Programs, land, and support for small and socially disadvantaged producers

Who This Is For

Black, Indigenous, and other historically underserved farmers have long faced barriers to land, credit, and the programs meant to support agriculture. A range of public and nonprofit resources exist specifically to help small and socially disadvantaged producers keep land, access funding, and build sustainable operations.

Heirs' Property and Land Retention

"Heirs' property" — land passed down without a clear written title — is a leading cause of Black land loss, because unclear ownership blocks access to loans and disaster aid and exposes families to forced sale. Clearing title and writing a will are among the most protective steps a landowning family can take.

- Seek legal aid that specializes in heirs' property and estate planning.
- Document the family tree and ownership history.
- Some programs now let heirs'-property operators obtain a farm number to access USDA programs.

Types of Support to Look For

Type	Examples of what it helps with
Cooperative Extension	Technical advice, soil testing, workshops
USDA programs	Farm loans, conservation cost-share, disaster aid
Nonprofit & cooperative groups	Training, advocacy, shared equipment, markets
Grants	Education, infrastructure, culturally responsive programs
Legal aid	Heirs' property, contracts, water rights

Building Programs That Fit the Community

Culturally responsive agricultural education — meeting growers where they are, honoring traditional knowledge alongside technical practice, and serving the actual needs of Black farming communities — tends to reach people that one-size-fits-all programming misses. Strong programs are built slowly, with trust, and in partnership with the communities they serve.